



The Commandment of Entry

*Our plans miscarry because they have no aim.
When a man does not know what harbor he is making for,
no wind is the right wind.*

~ SENECA

YOU CAN BE THE SHEEP OR THE SHEPHERDER

It was 1994 and I was stuffed in a hot auditorium, tucked away in a chaotic mass of people—an ant submersed in an anthill. Months earlier, I had become involved in a network marketing company, and this was their monthly motivational meeting. The crowd was excited, anxious, and revved up.

I wasn't. I looked around and saw a problem. I saw an army of drones clutching onto whatever was said, critical reasoning cast aside, and myself about to be indoctrinated. I didn't go so easy. I asked questions. I was persistent, nosy, and curious about the road I was about to take.

"How much money are you making?" I asked early and often. Like politicians, the answer was sideswiped and deflected to a default person in the organization, but I wasn't fooled. OK, you've already told me that Bill Hanson makes \$30,000 a month, but how much do *you* make? And you? And you? And the other 3,000 people in this room? The fact is, few of them made any money at all. Why? They were stuck driving a congested road full of traffic that failed the Commandment of Entry. Crowded, jammed roads move slowly, if at all.